

INCIDENT REPORT · REAL, VERIFIED

Incident ID: INC-REAL-2025-001

Date: June 8, 2025

Facility: Visakhapatnam Steel Plant (Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited - RINL)

Location: Steel Melt Shop-1, Caster-2

Equipment Involved: Ladle (molten steel transfer vessel), overhead crane

Description:

At approximately 4:15 PM, Caster-2 of Steel Melt Shop-1 at Visakhapatnam Steel Plant was in the process of casting. Before the slide gate could open to pour hot crude steel from the ladle into the tundish (and subsequently to the caster), a sudden and severe explosion occurred. A severe fireball rose to the ceiling, and Overhead Crane-2 caught fire as a result.

Casualties: 8 workers died from injuries sustained in the explosion. 6 additional workers were injured and hospitalized, with 2 in critical condition at the time of initial reporting.

Preliminary Cause Assessment:

Visakhapatnam Regional Fire Officer D. Niranjan Reddy stated the blast may have been triggered by impurities in the molten metal, or may have occurred due to a process-related issue. As of the initial Ministry of Steel statement, the exact root cause had not yet been determined and was under investigation.

Investigation Status:

Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited (RINL) opened an internal investigation. Additionally, the Ministry of Steel assigned a 3-member external enquiry committee, led by the Director-in-Charge of Bokaro (SAIL), to investigate the accident independently.

Official Statement:

Union Minister of State for Heavy Industries and Steel, Bhupathiraju Srinivasa Varma, confirmed the incident publicly and stated industrial safety remains a top priority, extending support to affected workers and families.

Source: Ministry of Steel, Government of India (public statement); news coverage including Zee News, June 2025.

Relevance to Regulatory Framework:

This incident falls under the general industrial safety oversight of the Factories Act 1948 (worker safety in hazardous processes) and is illustrative of the kind of high-consequence, process-related failure that OISD standards on equipment inspection and safe operating procedures are designed to prevent. No specific OISD standard number is confirmed as directly cited in public reporting for this incident.

Data Provenance Note:

This is a real, publicly documented industrial incident, included to supplement the synthetic operational dataset used elsewhere in this project. Unlike the generated work orders, inspection reports, and shift logs, this record reflects an actual verified event and is not fabricated for demonstration purposes.